

MedVoice AI

What to Buy — Now vs. Later

Purchasing Guide with Dependencies

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Abstract

You are at **Phase 1.5** (live contract spike). Most of the platform is built — you only pay for what unblocks the next gate. This document lists every purchase in sequence with costs and dependencies.

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1 Buy NOW — Phase 1.5 Spike (\$~ \$10 – –15total)

These are the **only** purchases needed to place one real call and verify Vapi contracts.

#	What	Cost	Why now	Depends on
1	Vapi account	\$10 free credit	Phone + default STT/LLM/voice	—
2	Vapi phone number	~\$1–2/mo	Something to dial	Vapi account
3	ngrok (or CF Tunnel)	Free tier	Public HTTPS → :3001	—

1.1 Do NOT buy yet for the spike

- Twilio — use Vapi-provided number
- Deepgram, ElevenLabs, OpenAI keys — Vapi defaults handle spike
- Google Calendar — spike uses `capture_lead` only
- Hosting, domain, Stripe, HIPAA hosting

1.2 Configure free (no purchase)

```
VAPI_WEBHOOK_SECRET=<random-string>
VAPI_SPIKE_MODE=true
PUBLIC_URL=https://xxxx.ngrok-free.app
```

Spike spend estimate: ~\$2–5 in Vapi minutes. Rest covered by \$10 credit.

2 Buy NEXT — After Spike Passes (Phase 2 prep)

Still no clinic revenue; still dev/pilot.

#	What	Cost	When	Depends on
4	ngrok paid (optional)	~\$8–20/mo	Free tier limits	Spike done
5	Domain name	~\$12–15/yr	Stable URL vs ngrok	Contracts verified
6	Google Cloud project	Free	Calendar call #2	Spike + clinic calendar

Google Calendar uses a **service account** (no charge). Clinic shares calendar with service account email.

3 Buy for PILOT — Phase 3 (\$~ \$50 – –150/movariable)

After fixtures match reality and you have a pilot clinic.

#	What	Cost	When	Depends on
7	Twilio account	~\$1.15/mo/number + ~\$0.01/min	Clinic number in Vapi	Spike + pilot
8	OpenAI API (BYOK)	~\$0.003–0.01/min	Better LLM	Vapi account
9	Deepgram (BYOK)	~\$0.004–0.02/min	Production STT	Vapi account
10	ElevenLabs (BYOK)	~\$0.01–0.07/min	Natural voice	Vapi account
11	Vapi platform fee	\$0.05/min	Every phone minute	Ongoing
12	Hosting (Railway/Render)	~\$5–25/mo	Replace ngrok	Domain optional

Pilot all-in: ~\$0.18–0.28/min | **500 min/mo:** ~\$90–140 + hosting

Set `VAPI_SPIKE_MODE=false` for full assistant with calendar tools.

4 Buy for FIRST PAYING CLIENT — Phase 4

#	What	Cost	When	Depends on
13	HIPAA hosting (AWS/Railway BAA)	~\$50–200/mo	Before real PHI	Pilot proven
14	BAAs (all providers)	\$0–paid tier	Before PHI on phone	Accounts above
15	Stripe	2.9% + \$0.30/charge	First invoice	Product ready
16	Sentry	Free → ~\$26/mo	Production deploy	Hosting
17	Google Workspace	~\$6/user/mo	Professional ops	Optional

Non-negotiable: BAAs before clinic sends real patient names/DOB on phone.

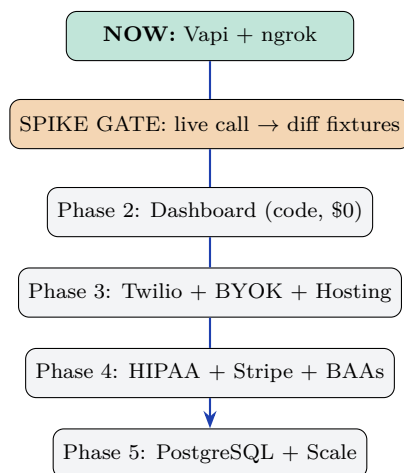
5 Buy for SCALE — Phase 5+ (10+ clinics)

#	What	Cost	When	Depends on
18	PostgreSQL (managed)	~\$15–50/mo	>10 tenants	Multi-tenant SaaS
19	Vapi extra concurrency	\$10/line/mo	Many simultaneous calls	Volume
20	Datadog / uptime	~\$15–100/mo	SLA promises	Production
21	n8n Cloud	~\$20/mo or self-host	CRM automations	Webhooks
22	LiveKit (optional)	~\$50–500/mo	High volume margin	Cost vs Vapi
23	SOC 2 / HIPAA audit	\$10K–50K once	Enterprise sales	Revenue

6 What Stays FREE

Item	Notes
Node / Express / SQLite	Local dev
React dashboard	Local dev
Ollama	Web widget demo only — not production phone
Vapi API docs + fixtures	Contract-first dev
Your platform code	Auth, tenants, tools, webhooks
ngrok free tier	Spike only
Google Calendar API	Free quota
GitHub	Repo + CI later

7 Dependency Map



8 Shopping List — Today

1. Sign up at <https://dashboard.vapi.ai> — \$10 credit
2. Create API key → VAPI_API_KEY in .env
3. Provision one Vapi phone number in dashboard
4. Install ngrok → free account
5. Generate VAPI_WEBHOOK_SECRET (long random string)

Total cash out today: \$0 if credit covers number + minutes.

9 What NOT to Buy Until Each Gate

Don't buy yet	Wait until
Twilio	Spike pass (Vapi number first)
Deepgram / ElevenLabs / OpenAI	Spike pass (defaults for call #1)
Google Calendar setup	Spike call #1 pass (call #2)
Domain + production hosting	Spike pass + pilot ready
Stripe	First client ready to pay
HIPAA hosting + BAAs	Pilot works + real PHI
LiveKit	High volume makes Vapi fee painful

10 Monthly Cost Model (Pricing Reference)

Selling at **\$1,500–2,500/mo** per clinic with ~1,000 min/mo:

Layer	Cost/clinic/mo
Vapi platform	~\$50
STT + LLM + TTS + Twilio	~\$130–280
Hosting (amortized)	~\$10–30
Your cost floor	~\$190–360

Price above **\$500–800/mo** minimum for margin. Medical market supports **\$1,500+**.

Companion: docs/PHASE-3-SPIKE.md · docs/CONTRACT-FIRST-PLAN.md